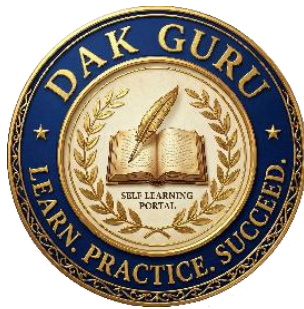




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Consolidation of Products & Centralized Delivery Policy

Comprehensive Study Notes for LDCE IP & PS Group 'B' Examinations

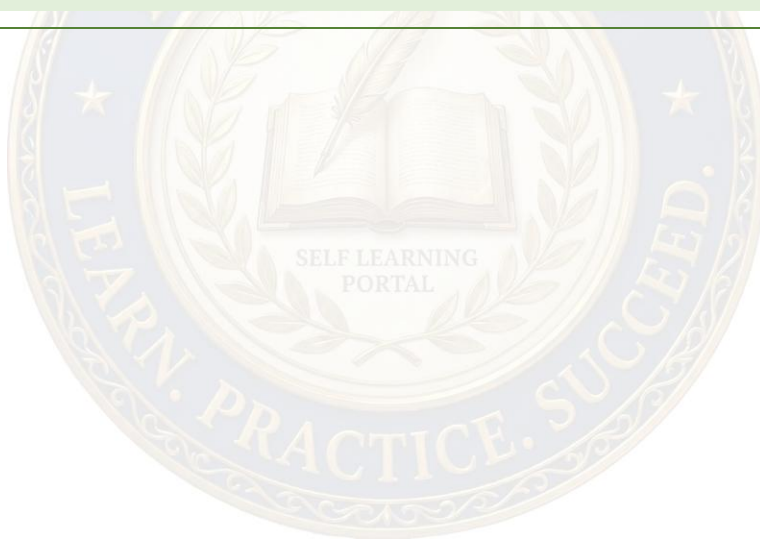
DISCLAIMER

This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. While every effort has been made to ensure accuracy and to incorporate the latest changes, amendments, orders, and notifications relating to the relevant Acts, Rules, and Regulations in force, this document is intended solely as a study aid. Readers and aspirants are strongly advised to refer to the official gazette notifications and the original orders of the Department of Posts / Government of India for the most authoritative and up-to-date position.

BASED ON LATEST ORDERS (Verified)

This edition has been updated and cross-checked against the following primary sources:

- Merger of Registered Post with Speed Post – Mail Operations Division letter No. Mail-30/5/2025-D-DoP dated 02.07.2025 (operational merger w.e.f. 01.09.2025).
- Rationalisation of Postal Products – Speed Post as basic accountable mail service & ‘Registration’ as a value-added service; revised Speed Post (Document) tariff – Gazette Notification No. 4256 dated 25.09.2025, effective 01.10.2025 (PIB, 26.09.2025).
- Common processing of Speed Post & Registered articles at one hub and bag-closing pattern – OM No. 30-10/2022-D dated 17.10.2024, 05.12.2024, and clarification dated 10.12.2024 (Annexure-A); network operational w.e.f. 09.12.2024.
- Policy Guidelines on Centralized Delivery of all types of articles through Delivery Centres – Postal Directorate letter No. 16-01/2025-D dated 17.02.2025, and Timelines circular No. 16-01/2024-D dated 03.03.2025.
- Mechanized delivery / fuel reimbursement – Mail Operations Division letter No. 16-02/2024-D dated 25.10.2024 (implemented w.e.f. 15.11.2024).



Part A – Consolidation of Postal Products & Services

1. Background: Rationalisation of Postal Products & Services

The Government of India, through the Department of Posts (Ministry of Communications), has undertaken a major exercise to rationalise (simplify and streamline) the suite of postal products and services. The objective is to remove duplication between similar services, modernise delivery in line with the private Courier, Express & Parcel (CEP) industry, and offer a single, technology-driven, accountable mail product to the public.

As part of this exercise, and keeping in view the legal requirements for delivery of summons, notices, and other statutory documents, it has been notified that Speed Post will now be the principal accountable mail service, while ‘Registration’ will continue to be available as a value-added service within the Speed Post framework.

KEY DATES – UNDERSTAND THE TWO STAGES

Stage 1 – Operational merger (w.e.f. 01.09.2025): Registered Post was merged into Speed Post for domestic transmission, per Mail Operations Division letter No. Mail-30/5/2025-D-DoP dated 02.07.2025. From this date, Registered Post ceased to exist as a separate, standalone service.

Stage 2 – Formal rationalisation & tariff revision (w.e.f. 01.10.2025): Speed Post was formally designated the basic accountable mail service and ‘Registration’ notified as a value-added service, along with a revised Speed Post (Document) tariff and new features — vide Gazette Notification No. 4256 dated 25.09.2025.

Exam tip: If a question asks when Registered Post was merged with Speed Post, the operational date is 01.09.2025; the rationalisation framework and new tariff are effective 01.10.2025. Do not confuse the two.

2. The Revised Framework

- **Speed Post (basic service):** Speed Post Document and Speed Post Parcel are now the basic mail service for address-specific delivery of accountable postal items within the country.
- **Registration (value-added service):** ‘Registration’ is a value-added service available only on Speed Post items (both documents and parcels). It provides addressee-specific delivery — the item is delivered exclusively to the addressee or a person duly authorised by the addressee.

- **Charge for Registration:** A nominal charge of ₹5 per Speed Post item (Document/Parcel), plus applicable GST, is levied for the value-added 'Registration' service.
- **OTP Delivery (new value-added service):** A separate value-added service of One-Time Password (OTP) Delivery is also available at ₹5 per item plus GST, under which the item is handed over only after the addressee successfully confirms the OTP shared with the delivery staff.
- **Exclusions:** 'Registration' is not available for any other category of mail; it is confined to Speed Post items only.
- **Concessions:** A 10% discount on the Speed Post tariff has been introduced for students, and a 5% discount for new bulk customers.

LEGISLATIVE / OPERATIONAL NOTE

The merger of the Registered Post service into Speed Post is operationally effective w.e.f. 01.09.2025 (DoP letter dated 02.07.2025). The notification designating Speed Post as the basic service with 'Registration' as a value-added service, together with the revised tariff, took effect w.e.f. 01.10.2025 vide Gazette Notification No. 4256 dated 25.09.2025.

3. Processing of Speed Post and Registered Articles at One Hub

POLICY SOURCE & CHAIN OF ORDERS

The common-processing and bag-closing framework in this Part flows from the following orders (all File No. 30-10/2022-D, Mail Operations / Mail Business Division):

- OM dated 17.10.2024 — decision to process Speed Post & Registered articles at one common hub (L1 → NSH, L2 → ICH).
- OM dated 05.12.2024 — revised network & bag-closing pattern; new operational network w.e.f. first set of 09.12.2024.
- OM dated 10.12.2024 — Clarification on bag-closing pattern; the detailed pattern is elaborated in Annexure-A (Domestic: NSH/ICH/inter- & intra-circle; International outbound per IR&GB OM dated 22.06.2023).

3.1 Bagging Protocol

- **Speed Post & Registered (single bag):** Only one Speed Post bag, carrying an Orange colour label and containing both Speed Post and Registered articles, will be sent across all miles — i.e., from Post Offices to the hubs, between the hubs, and from the hubs to the Post Offices.

- **Other (surface) articles:** Domestic Book Packets, Gyan Post (the earlier Registered Book Packets containing printed books), Periodicals, Registered Newspapers, Registered Newspaper bundles, Sample/Pattern packets, and Blind Literature carrying registration are also processed at hubs. Circles must earmark a separate area for these articles and process them separately.
- **Sorting & routing:** A separate sorting diagram is maintained for such (other) articles. After processing, they are dispatched through surface routes only.
- **Labelling:** These bags are closed under a Green colour bag label.

REMEMBER THE COLOUR CODE

Orange label → Speed Post + Registered articles (single combined bag, all miles).

Green label → Other / surface articles (Book Packets, Gyan Post, Periodicals, Registered Newspapers, Sample packets, Blind Literature) — surface route only.

3.2 Bag Closing Pattern in the Revised Network

Post Offices mapped with a National Sorting Hub (NSH) will close the following bags:

1. **TD Bag (Town Delivery):** Containing Speed Post and Registered articles to be delivered within the Post Offices mapped with that hub.
 2. **NTD Bag (Non-Town Delivery):** Containing articles to be delivered within the mapped Post Offices of other hubs.
- **Station articles:** Delivery Post Offices keep the station articles (those to be delivered within the delivery jurisdiction of the booking office itself) with themselves; there is no need to send such articles to the hub.
 - **Surface-route articles:** In addition, one TD and one NTD bag containing Domestic Book Packets, Gyan Post, Periodicals, Registered Newspapers, Registered Newspaper bundles, Sample/Pattern packets, and Blind Literature are prepared by the Post Offices for the hubs. These are handled by hubs separately through surface routes and closed under a Green colour bag label.

3.3 Post Offices Mapped with the Intra-Circle Hub (ICH)

A Post Office mapped with an ICH closes two accountable-mail (Speed Post + Registered) bags — a TD bag to its parent ICH and an NTD bag to the NSH:

- **TD Bag (to the parent ICH):** Containing articles to be delivered among the Post Offices of the mapped ICH, and the other ICHs and NSHs within the same Circle.

- **NTD Bag (to the NSH):** Containing articles to be delivered in the mapped Post Offices of the mapped NSH, and the Post Offices served by the hubs of other Circles.
- **Station articles:** As with NSH-mapped offices, station articles (for the booking office's own delivery jurisdiction) are retained and not sent to the hub.
- **Surface-route articles:** One TD and one NTD bag of the surface category (Book Packets, Gyan Post, Periodicals, Registered Newspapers, Sample/Pattern packets, Blind Literature) are also prepared for the hubs and sent under a Green colour bag label.

ASPIRANT QUERY – VERIFIED & ADDRESSED

Concern raised: the TD/NTD bag contents for ICH-mapped Post Offices differ from those in circular No. 30-10/2022-D dated 10.12.2024.

Position: The TD/NTD wording above is the summary pattern stated in the body of OM dated 05.12.2024 (File No. 30-10/2022-D), which it reproduces accurately. The OM dated 10.12.2024 (same file number) is a clarification that does NOT change this body text; it elaborates a more detailed, tabular bag-closing pattern in its Annexure-A (separately handling NSH/ICH and inter- vs intra-circle hub legs).

Action: *Field staff and aspirants must read the summary above together with Annexure-A of the 10.12.2024 clarification for the full, granular hub-leg-wise pattern. The detailed Annexure-A table is an attachment to that OM and should be consulted in its original form (it is not reproduced verbatim here, as the tabular Annexure-A could not be independently confirmed from a primary, openly-available source).*

3.4 Closing of Bags from the Hubs

- **Speed Post & Registered:** A single bag containing Speed Post and Registered articles for other hubs / mapped delivery offices is sent under an Orange colour label.
- **Surface articles:** Domestic Book Packets, Registered Book Packets (printed books), Periodicals, Registered Newspapers, Registered Newspaper bundles, Sample/Pattern packets, and Blind Literature are sent in a separate bag through surface route, under a Green colour bag label.
- **Transportation mode:** Hubs process the domestic packets and close bags for the destination as per the applicable transport mode (Air / Surface). The mode must be super-scribed in the right-hand corner of the label as either AIR or SURFACE.

3.5 International Track Packets (ITPS) — Bag Closing Pattern

- **POs mapped with ICHs:** Will close a direct, separate bag straight to their NSH only.
- **POs / IBCs (International Business Centres):** Close direct bags for outward ITPS and Registered/Insured letter-post articles (letter, small packet, Blind Literature, printed paper, M-Bag) to the mapped FPO/OE where the daily average is 15 articles or 10 kg of mail per category.
- **NSH responsibility:** For international outward mail, all NSHs close direct bags to the mapped FPOs only for Registered/Insured letter-post items and ITPS articles, and dispatch them by Air wherever an air connection is available.

4. Compensation Guidelines for Speed Post

A Speed Post article is treated as 'lost', in the absence of a final delivery status, for the purpose of payment of compensation, after the following maximum period:

TIME LIMIT — SPEED POST DOCUMENT (note 'whichever is LATER')

60 days from the date of booking, OR 30 days from the date of receipt of the complaint — **whichever is LATER** — provided the complaint is lodged within the prescribed period.

Compensation to the sender of an article so declared 'lost' is paid thereafter within 10 days.

Authority: DoP order on time limit for treating a Speed Post article as 'lost' — applicable to articles booked on or after 01.04.2021 (Rule 66-B of the Indian Post Office Rules, 1933).

DISTINGUISH — SPEED POST / BUSINESS PARCEL

For a Speed Post Parcel and Business Parcel, the time limit to treat the parcel as 'lost' was revised to 30 days from the date of booking or from the date of receipt of the complaint, whichever is later (Parcel Directorate OM No. 17-01/2019-PD dated 08.11.2023, superseding the earlier 60/30-day rule). For insured parcels, the existing rules apply.

Important distinction: the '60 days OR 30 days, whichever is later' rule applies to Speed Post documents/letters, whereas the parcel rule is '30 days, whichever is later'. The 10-day payment window applies once the article is declared lost.

Part B — Centralized Delivery of All Types of Articles

POLICY SOURCE

Policy Guidelines on Centralized Delivery of all types of postal articles (Speed Post, Registered, Parcel and ordinary articles) through Delivery Centres — Postal Directorate letter No. 16-01/2025-D dated 17.02.2025. Phased (Brownfield) roll-out timelines — circular No. 16-01/2024-D dated 03.03.2025.

5. Concept and Rationale of Delivery Centres

At present India Post maintains a network of about 19,500 delivery Post Offices — one of the largest delivery networks in the world. However, most are single- or double-handed offices where delivery is mixed with counter work and monitoring is weak. To handle rapidly growing volumes (accountable document volume is projected to grow to about 164 crore by 2028-29 from about 94 crore, and parcels to about 46 crore from about 6.7 crore), the Department is setting up dedicated Delivery Centres (DCs) on the model of private CEP players.

- **Integrated delivery:** A Delivery Centre with mechanisation of all delivery areas can deliver every type of article — Speed Post documents, Registered Post, parcels, ordinary mail, eMOs, etc. — from a single facility.
- **Larger coverage, less travel time:** Mechanisation lets delivery staff cover a much larger area with a considerable reduction in travel time.
- **Separation from counters:** Delivery Centres have no counter operations and have dedicated supervisory staff, which improves monitoring and lets Post Office staff focus on counter work.
- **Flexible delivery:** Delivery Centres enable Sunday/holiday delivery, morning or evening delivery, and a second delivery of mail — as is normal in the CEP (Courier, Express & Parcel) market — and support Next-Day-Delivery services.

6. Types of Delivery Centres (by location of Document & Parcel processing areas)

Ideally, the document and parcel processing areas should be located adjacent to each other in an integrated Delivery Centre. Where suitable adjacent space is not available, the parcel processing area is located in the same plot/compound, though not adjacent.

6.1 Integrated Delivery Centre — Document and Parcel areas co-located

The document and parcel processing areas are adjacent, with a common bag receipt and dispatch area. Delivery staff may be assigned in two ways:

- **Separate delivery staff:** Separate staff for document and parcel delivery may be assigned, subject to justification for separate parcel-delivery staff (explained in the workload norms below).
- **Mix delivery staff:** If separate parcel-delivery staff is not justified, the same delivery staff are assigned both document and parcel delivery in the delivery area.

6.2 Delivery Centre with separately located processing areas (not adjacent)

- Document and parcel processing areas are at a distance from each other, though within the same compound.
- A separate area for parcel processing is considered only if separate parcel-delivery staff is justified.
- Bag receipt and dispatch areas are different for the document and the parcel areas.
- Separate delivery staff are assigned for documents and for parcels.
- **Nomenclature:** In such cases the document delivery centre is called the “Delivery Centre” and the parcel delivery centre is called the “Nodal Delivery Centre (NDC)”.
- **Layout reference:** Instructions issued by the Parcel Directorate on setting up NDCs (layout design, number of delivery staff, etc.) are followed for the parcel area.

7. Process Flow in a Delivery Centre

7.1 Integrated DC – Separate Delivery Staff for Document and Parcel

Common steps (common area): Receipt of bag from MMS → Bag Receipt Scan. The specific flow then is:

Step	Ordinary Mail	Accountable Mail	Parcels
1	Opening of bag	Opening of bag (incl. Article Receipt Scan)	Opening of bag (incl. Article Receipt Scan & Sector Sorting)
2	Segregation & facing of ordinary mail	Sorting	Delivery-area-wise sorting
3	Stamping of ordinary mail	Sequencing	Sequencing
4	Sorting	Scanning & generation of Delivery Slip	Scanning & generation of Delivery Slip
5	Sequencing	Out of Delivery	Out of Delivery
6	Out of Delivery	Taking of Delivery Staff Return	Taking of Delivery Staff Return
7	Taking of Delivery Staff Return	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub
8	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub	Tallying of Abstract	Tallying of Abstract
9	Tallying of Abstract	—	—

7.2 Integrated DC – Mix Delivery Staff for Document and Parcel

Common steps (common area): Receipt of bag from MMS → Bag Receipt Scan. The key difference is that a Common Delivery Slip is generated for document and parcel together:

Step	Ordinary Mail	Accountable Mail	Parcels
1	Opening of bag	Opening of bag (incl. Article Receipt Scan)	Opening of bag (incl. Article Receipt Scan & Sector Sorting)
2	Segregation & facing of ordinary mail	Sorting	Delivery-area-wise sorting
3	Stamping of ordinary mail	Sequencing	Sequencing

Step	Ordinary Mail	Accountable Mail	Parcels
4	Sorting	Scanning & Common Delivery Slip (Doc + Parcel)	Scanning & Common Delivery Slip (Doc + Parcel)
5	Sequencing	Out of Delivery	Out of Delivery
6	Out of Delivery	Taking of Delivery Staff Return	Taking of Delivery Staff Return
7	Taking of Delivery Staff Return	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub
8	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub	Tallying of Abstract	Tallying of Abstract
9	Tallying of Abstract	—	—

7.3 Separately Located Processing Areas

Where the document and parcel processing areas are in the same compound but not adjacent, the document and parcel areas each follow their own flow.

A. Document Processing Area

Step	Ordinary Mail	Accountable Mail
Receipt	Receipt of bags from MMS (common area)	Receipt of bags from MMS (common area)
Scan	Bag Receipt Scan (common area)	Bag Receipt Scan (common area)
1	Opening of bags	Opening of bags (incl. Article Receipt Scan)
2	Segregation & facing of ordinary mail	Sorting
3	Stamping of ordinary mail	Sequencing
4	Sorting	Scanning & generation of Delivery Slip
5	Sequencing	Out of Delivery
6	Out of Delivery	Taking of Delivery Staff Return
7	Taking of Delivery Staff Return	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub
8	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub	Tallying of Abstract
9	Tallying of Abstract	—

B. Parcel Processing Area

Step	Parcels
Receipt	Receipt of bags from MMS
Scan	Bag Receipt Scan
1	Opening of bag (incl. Parcel Receipt Scan & Sector Sorting)
2	Delivery-area-wise sorting
3	Sequencing
4	Scanning & generation of Delivery Slip
5	Out of Delivery
6	Taking of Delivery Staff Return
7	Bag despatch to Sorting Hub
8	Tallying of Abstract

SCANNING OF BAGS

The Supervisor / In-charge of the Delivery Centre must ensure that bags are scanned both at the time of actual receipt from the mail motor and at the time of actual dispatch through the mail motor.

8. Guidelines for Setting Up Delivery Centres

8.1 Delivery Area / Delivery PIN Codes

- **Merger:** The delivery areas of adjoining delivery Post Offices may be merged under one newly set-up Delivery Centre.
- **Redesign:** Existing delivery beats may be discontinued and the delivery area under the new Delivery Centre redesigned/recalibrated based on the overall delivery area.
- **Distance limit:** The area should be redesigned so that the one-way distance to be travelled by delivery staff is not more than 15 km. In exceptional circumstances, it may exceed 15 km as per operational requirements.
- **Layout:** An integrated DC (document and parcel co-located) is designed as per the Model Layout. For a separate parcel area, the layout in the Parcel Design Manual circulated by the Parcel Directorate is referred to.

8.2 Delivery of Parcels through Delivery Centres

- As far as possible, parcels should be delivered through Delivery Centres, with parcel processing areas identified separately.
- Existing NDCs in a city may be merged with Delivery Centres, either immediately or over a period of time if immediate merger is not feasible.
- New NDCs opened due to unavailability of suitable space may also be merged with Delivery Centres over time.
- Where separate parcel-delivery staff is justified, the parcel delivery area is carved out separately and need not be co-terminus with the document delivery area.
- If separate parcel-delivery staff is not justified, a common delivery staff is assigned for both document and parcel delivery, and a separate parcel delivery area need not be carved out — though a separate parcel processing area may still be identified for smooth processing.

8.3 Mechanized Delivery

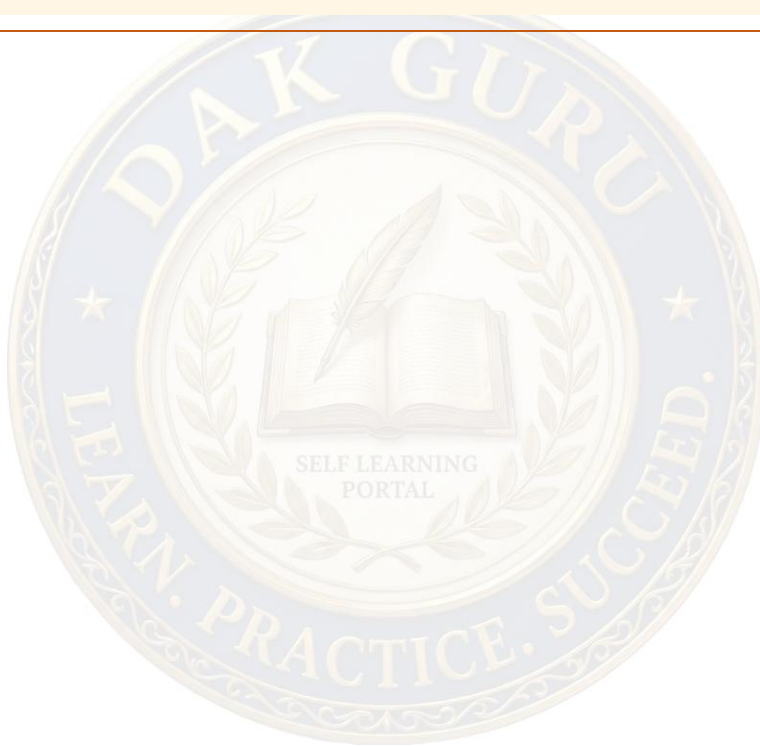
- All delivery areas in a Delivery Centre must be mechanised — delivery is performed only through a 2-wheeler, or a 4-wheeler for heavy parcels.
- Documents and small parcels are delivered through 2-wheelers; big and heavy parcels through 4-wheelers.
- **Fuel reimbursement:** Fuel reimbursement charges for delivery staff using their own 2-wheeler are paid monthly, as per the policy guidelines issued by the Postal

Directorate vide Letter No. 16-02/2024-D dated 25.10.2024 (implemented w.e.f. 15.11.2024).

- **Hired e-vehicles:** Circles/Regions/Divisions may hire electric 2-wheelers through a tendered process for staff who do not own a 2-wheeler.
- **4-wheelers:** 4-wheelers may be hired as per existing practice; India Post branding on the hired 4-wheeler must be ensured.

✓ **CORRECTION – NOTE THE LETTER DATE**

The fuel-reimbursement policy is contained in Letter No. 16-02/2024-D dated 25.10.2024 (not 25.11.2024). The mechanisation policy was introduced on 25.10.2024 and came into effect on 15.11.2024.



9. Workload Norms – Number of Articles

The following are the tentative numbers of accountable, unregistered, and other articles normally delivered by one delivery staff under a Delivery Centre.

9.1 Mix Delivery Area (per delivery staff)

Category of Article	Tentative Number
Ordinary articles	95
Regd. articles / Speed Post (person-specific) / Parcels	42
Speed Post (Document)	43
Money Order / eMO	1
COD	3
Insured	1

ASSUMPTIONS & EXCLUSIONS

Note 1: These figures assume a distance of 30 km / 18 km (less-congested / congested area) and a travel time of 90 minutes. Actual numbers may differ from centre to centre and should be taken into account.

Note 2: While calculating the number of delivery staff required, bulk-delivery articles must not be included.

9.2 Exclusive Parcel Delivery Staff (per staff)

Category	Tentative Number
Speed Post / Business / Regd. Parcel	60

9.3 Bulk Delivery

1–2 bulk-delivery staff (or as required) are identified exclusively in each Delivery Centre to deliver bulk articles received for addresses within the DC's delivery area.

10. Number of Delivery Centres in a City

10.1 Metro Cities / Other Big Cities

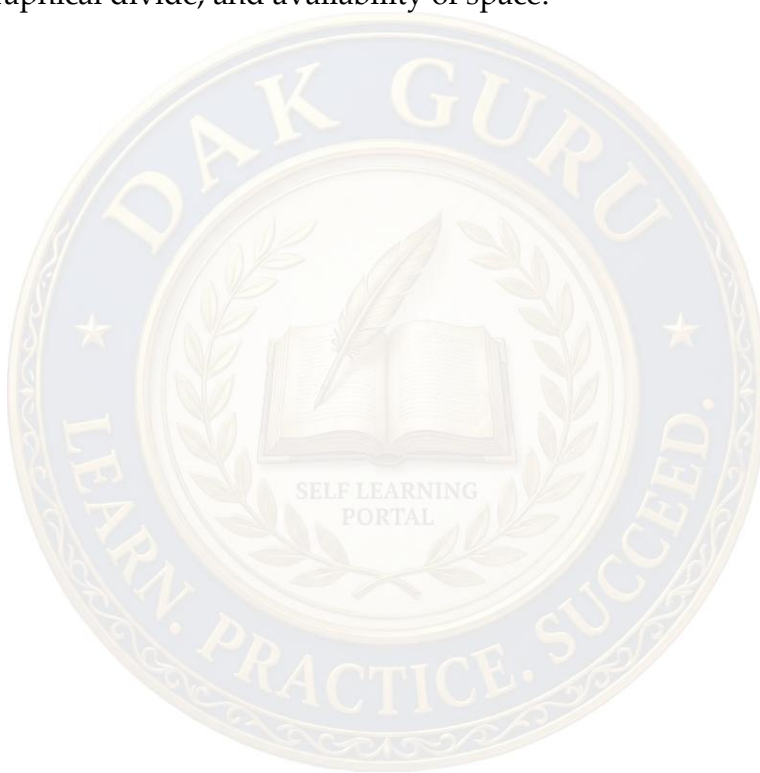
- In metro/big cities delivering more than 50,000 accountable articles/parcels (except bulk) per day, a DC may cater to about 50–80 delivery staff, with the corresponding number of articles. The number of DCs in the city is derived accordingly.

- If sufficient space is available to cater to more staff, the 50–80 range can be exceeded.
- **Maximum limit:** The maximum number of accountable articles that can be delivered by one DC is kept at 8,000 articles per day (except bulk).

10.2 State Capitals / Other Cities

- A DC may cater to about 15–60 delivery staff, with the corresponding number of articles; the number of DCs is derived accordingly.
- **Maximum limit:** The maximum number of accountable articles that can be delivered by one DC is kept at 5,000 articles per day (except bulk).

The number of delivery staff per DC may differ from the above based on unique factors such as distance, geographical divide, and availability of space.



11. Infrastructure and Facilities

11.1 Space Requirement

Type of City	Delivery Staff	Estimated Area
Metro / Other Big Cities	≈ 50–80	≈ 2,000 – 3,500 Sq. Ft.
State Capitals / Other Cities	≈ 15–60	≈ 1,000 – 2,500 Sq. Ft.

- **Parking:** While selecting a location, adequate parking space for the 2-wheelers and 4-wheelers engaged at the DC must be ensured.

11.2 Facility ID for Delivery Centre

A separate Facility ID is created for each Delivery Centre (and Nodal Delivery Centre, if applicable) to give the office a separate identity in CSI and to ensure availability of monitoring data in the various BI/MIS reports.

11.3 Deployment of Staff

The availability of a 2-wheeler vehicle and a smart mobile phone with the delivery staff must be ensured at the time of selecting Departmental/GDS staff as delivery staff for the Delivery Centre.

11.4 PIN Code to be Used

- Each DC may be assigned the PIN code of any of the merged delivery Post Offices whose delivery areas it serves.
- Ideally, the delivery PIN code of the major delivery PO is assigned to the DC.
- CEPT will map all the delivery PIN codes to the DC's PIN code and make the necessary changes in BI/MIS reports.

11.5 Standardization across Delivery Centres

- A ramp may be provided at the entry of the DC for receipt/dispatch of bags via the bag trolley.
- Each area in the DC (bag receipt area, bag opening area, etc.) is marked as per the defined process flow.

12. Operational Guidelines

12.1 Delivery Slips

- **Mix delivery area:** A common Delivery Slip is generated, containing Speed Post documents, Registered Post, and parcels together.
- **Separate parcel area:** Delivery slips for documents and parcels are generated separately.
- **Bulk Delivery Slip:** The Supervisor/In-charge ensures a Bulk Delivery Slip is generated for articles delivered in bulk.

12.2 Postman Mobile App (PMA)

- All delivery staff are equipped with mobile phones — Departmental or under the Bring Your Own Device (BYOD) scheme. The availability of the PMA is ensured at the time of selection of delivery staff.
- Advanced functionalities are being introduced in the PMA under the IT 2.0 project — route optimisation, paperless delivery, OTP-based delivery, digital collection of payment, app-based calling to the addressee, etc.

12.3 Call to Customer ★

The delivery staff make a call to the addressee before visiting the address, to expedite delivery.

12.4 Delivery of eMO / COD / Custom Duty Articles

- Delivery staff collect the required cash for delivery of Money Order/eMO from the designated official at the DC.
- After delivery of COD / Custom duty articles / undelivered eMO, staff submit the cash collected from addressees to the designated official.
- Amounts collected digitally towards COD / Custom duty are settled and accounted for automatically by the designated official.

12.5 Equipment in the Delivery Centre

Computers and scanners are supplied as per existing specifications. The following operational equipment is provided:

Document Processing Area	Parcel Processing Area
(a) Opening table for ordinary mail	(a) Opening table
(b) Sorting case	(b) Sequencing table

Document Processing Area	Parcel Processing Area
(c) Roller containers	(c) Package trolley
(d) Stamping table	(d) Roller containers
(e) Postman table	(e) Standardized delivery bags

12.6 Treasury Function

Each Delivery Centre with a separate Facility ID may be provided with a treasury function — to disburse cash to delivery staff for payment of money orders, etc., and to receive cash collected towards COD, custom duty, undelivered money orders, etc.

12.7 Number of Delivery Re-attempts

- Two delivery attempts may be made for documents or parcels; undelivered articles are kept in deposit for a maximum of 7 days.
- Existing instructions on serving intimation to the addressee must be strictly followed.

12.8 Number of Shifts / Second Delivery

- A normal DC works to normal delivery timing, with delivery staff duty hours fixed from 09:00 to 17:00 hrs. Timing may be altered as per local factors.
- Considering growing volumes and customer requirements, second delivery services may be started — a morning delivery and an evening delivery (as in RMS offices) — enabling the DC to deliver roughly twice the number of articles.

Field-unit guidelines for second delivery:

- **Duty timing:** Morning/First Delivery 09:00–17:00 hrs; Evening/Second Delivery 12:00–20:00 hrs.
- **Facility ID:** A separate Facility ID is created for the morning-shift DC and the evening-shift DC to give each a separate identity.
- **Supervisor & Delivery PA:** Separate Supervisors and Delivery PAs are provided for the First and Second delivery sets, and for the Nodal Delivery Centre (where the parcel area is not co-located).

12.9 Sunday / Holiday Delivery

- Each DC performs delivery on Sundays and public holidays as per requirement.
- Delivery staff serving office areas may not be operationalised on Sundays/public holidays.

- Duties of Departmental/GDS delivery staff are fixed so as to ensure a weekly off to each such staff.

12.10 Provision of CCTV

Each DC is covered by CCTV so as to cover the outside of the DC, including the bag-exchange area with the mail motor, and the processing areas inside. An SOP for installation of CCTVs was issued by the Department on 25th February 2021.

12.11 Access Control

The Supervisor/In-charge ensures that only authorised staff enter the Delivery Centre. Entry of outside persons inside the DC is not permitted.



Part C — Quick Revision (Exam Pointers)

MOST-ASKED FACTS AT A GLANCE

- Registered Post merged into Speed Post — operational w.e.f. 01.09.2025 (letter dated 02.07.2025).
- Speed Post = basic accountable service; 'Registration' = value-added service — w.e.f. 01.10.2025 (Gazette No. 4256 dated 25.09.2025).
- Registration charge ₹5 + GST per item; OTP Delivery ₹5 + GST per item.
- Bag labels: Orange = Speed Post + Registered (single bag); Green = other/surface articles.
- ICH-mapped PO: TD bag → parent ICH (mapped ICH + other ICHs/NSHs within Circle); NTD bag → NSH (mapped NSH POs + other-Circle hub POs). See Annexure-A of OM 30-10/2022-D dated 10.12.2024 for the detailed pattern.
- Speed Post Document 'lost': 60 days from booking OR 30 days from complaint, whichever is LATER; pay within 10 days.
- Speed Post/Business Parcel 'lost': 30 days, whichever is later (OM 17-01/2019-PD dated 08.11.2023).
- DC one-way delivery distance: not more than 15 km (exceptions permitted).
- Max accountable articles/day per DC: Metro/Big city 8,000; State Capital/Other 5,000 (except bulk).
- Re-attempts: 2; undelivered kept in deposit max 7 days.
- Shifts: First 09:00–17:00; Second 12:00–20:00. CCTV SOP dated 25.02.2021.
- Fuel reimbursement policy: Letter No. 16-02/2024-D dated 25.10.2024 (effective 15.11.2024).

— End of Booklet —

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